GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

February 6th, 2026
Week 6
Volume 281, Issue 1222

Highlights:

- **Gravitational drop.**
- **Still shortage.**
- **Older handies.**
- **Steel settle.**
- **Concerns afoot.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"If you're brave enough to say goodbye, life will reward you with a new hello."

– Paulo Coehlo

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SEARCH OF LIFE!

The weekly roller coaster that has become the global marketplace went through its regular gravitational drop this week, with the U.S. dollar taking the "cement-footed diving approach" in all ship-recycling destinations… except—you guessed it—Turkey!

The Baltic Exchange Dry Bulk Index fell 0.7% down to a two-week low, dragged by the Capesize index, which fell a massive 1.1% over the week. The Panamax index slipped a comparatively more acceptable 0.4%, while the Supramax index rose a modest 0.2% to even things out. Meanwhile, easing tensions between the U.S. and Iran alleviated concerns over potential supply disruptions erupting out of the Middle East (thanks, Donnie), resulting in oil falling below USD 62/barrel, yet it managed to crawl ahead and close Friday at USD 63.15/barrel.

As we slip past oil discussions and into the Indian sub-continent ship-recycling destinations, faint signs of life have certainly started to show (at least at the waterfronts) as we head further into February, after an inert start to the year produced some worrying reversals that seemed like the visiting mother-in-law who wasn't planning on leaving (still feels like that way somehow). Local steel prices surged this week with all sub-continent destinations reporting major jumps across the week.

The shortage of recycling candidates meanwhile continues to flirt with a starving industry that is seeing stars and demand ramp up once again, following what has been a general theme over the years, accompanied by record-low sales due to continually firm freight markets on the back of some new global crisis that somehow never misses a beat to arrive for a paycheck. Older handy bulkers and LNGs have certainly been sold at the start of this year, and at some firming levels too, but tankers (for the most part) and containers have been absent over the last few years.

Bangladeshi elections are also on the horizon and the government has widened the local holiday period to ensure everyone has time to register their vote. All sub-continent recycling destinations meanwhile have had their own unique port positions to report for the week, with Chattogram leading the way once again. That can't be happening, right? Turkey at the far end remains relatively quiet again, with no news of freshly proposed market units of late.

As Fun February breaks in, it's looking set to be another quiet 2026, especially as geopolitical shocks continue to keep trading markets propped up —be it by men in suits or in traditional clothing.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 6 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

ELECTION SPECULATION?

Back in the picture.

After a worrying start to the year that saw local offerings placed firmly below the psychological barrier of USD 400/LDT—and Bangladesh even slipping to the bottom of the market rankings for a week—Chattogram seems to have slipped back into the picture this week, not only through local discussions but also with a local anchorage that remained busy, including local deliveries from last week that were promptly delivered when the tide broke this week, as well as the welcome arrival of a rare large LDT tanker.

Critical event.

The performance of domestic fundamentals certainly played its part with the Taka spiking 0.65% against the U.S. dollar this week and venturing off into the weekend at BDT 122.05. Local steel plate prices also shockingly woke up after two horizontal weeks (with no local trading being reported) and jumped nearly USD 9/ton clock out at almost USD 494/ton, giving local recyclers that much more of a buffer on the state of current purchases—because for the upcoming units? Who knows where the markets might stand then.

More progressive?

Meanwhile, shades of pre-election speculation are starting to take grip the nation as the critical election day is due to take place by mid-February, and the usual flurry of lobbying, rallying, and breakout instances of political violence continue to mar headlines across the nation. If, as is being hoped for, a more progressive pro-business party is elected to power, we could see a surge in local markets off the back of long-delayed infrastructure projects being resumed, with optimism finally returning to the nation as a result.

Land of no return.

For now, however, as Chattogram continues to confuse with its weekly performance—where last week it felt like a "land of no return"—this week feels like a whole new personality breaking through the seams yet again. Seems like Mr. Hyde is out and about once again.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

SECURE ME SOME!

Alang buyers have reportedly managed to secure some interesting market / private units of late (and this week), including another high-profile LNG and several smaller LDT units positioned in the region, whilst Pakistan and Bangladesh went for the larger dry bulk units in the parade.

LNGs still.

Moreover, even though there was another arrival of a rare large LDT tanker, most of the deliveries (just like in Chattogram) were those from last week, taking the total LDT at Alang to just over 36K, for what has been a terrible few weeks thus far.

And while local steel plate prices have primarily been the driving force behind the disaster that has been Alang's constant re-positioning on the market rankings of late, this week saw a whole new face as not only did local steel plate prices jump USD 14/ton to nearly USD 415/ton, but the U.S. dollar also lost a massive 1.32% against the Indian Rupee and closed shop for the week at INR 90.08, looking ready to break back into Rs. 89.X territory (hopefully next week).

Rupee concerns.

On the HKC front, with nearly all recycling yards in Alang being HKC-certified—23 in Chattogram and two in Gadani (with more on the way)—India will still hold the advantage in this regard, even if (and whenever) competitors catch up and an abundance of tonnage forces sellers toward Alang. Only one of these will sadly be true for the foreseeable future.

HKC advantage.

For now, regardless of the performance of the competition and where India lands on the market rankings week after week, Alang will always be a home for a unit being proposed on the bidding tables.

Week after week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

LEADING WAY?

Stunning reversal.

After what can only be described as a stunning reversal of fortunes since the start of this year, Pakistan has surprisingly been leading the way in the sub-continent ship-recycling sector over the last few weeks, including this one, where several Panamax and handy bulker sales have reportedly taken place to hungry local recyclers. And from the looks of it, there is still further demand from a hungry few to import vessels at decent levels, still exceeding USD 400/LDT.

Like the rest of the industry, domestic fundamentals have been the trampoline bounce that Gadani recyclers have been desperately looking for, as local steel plate prices finally broke through their cemented coffins and surged nearly USD 8/ton, closing the week out at an industry leading USD 597/ton. Not wanting to be left behind, the Pakistani Rupee also seized the moment this week and surged 1% against the U.S. Dollar, registering a closing bell of PKR 279.14.

Dry bulk sales.

And what really snapped the camel's back this week was the arrival of a near 7K LDT unit at Gadani's anchorage, breaking what has been a tediously deserted 2026 for the nation's waterfront thus far. Moreover, with so many rumors of private and market fixtures to the Gadani Gang over the last couple of weeks, the immediate future remains an exciting one to keep an eye on.

Finally, further good news enveloped the market at the start of this year, as the second HKC yard was approved in Gadani and announced in recent weeks. We are finally starting to see the requisite infrastructure being laid out across the shores of Gadani to ensure the survival of this industry in the decades ahead.

Good HKC news.

With Chattogram decidedly out of the running during election time and tonnage seemingly squeaking its way onto the bidding tables, it's certainly an exciting time for the Gadani Gang after what feels like an eternity on the sidelines.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STILL LIFE

Other than a stage of momentum for Aliaga recyclers with roro deliveries over recent weeks, it seems as though its back to basics for this market, with nothing new to report other than a Lira that was the only ship recycling destination to lose 20 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and clock out at TRY 43.58, merrily on its way to breach TRY 44.

Seems like some serious anti-gravity UAP like performance from the Lira.

UAP.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 6 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Improving**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ANOTHER…2025 IN REVIEW!!

- *Apr 16: Chess grandmaster Ju Wenjun won her fifth Women's World Chess Championship title in a row.*
- *May 03: Lady Gaga's free "Mayhem on the Beach" concert at Rio's Copacabana beach drew over 2.5 million fans.*
- *May 04: Donald Trump announced that he would impose a 100% tariff on all films "produced in foreign lands" and imported into the U.S.*
- *May 08: Cardinal Robert Provost was elected as the 267th pope, taking on the name Pope Leo XIV.*
- *May 28: An Alpine village in Switzerland was completely wiped off the map by the collapse of a glacier.*
- *Jun 04: Over 20,000 residents of Cologne, Germany, were evacuated after three US bombs from WWII were dug up.*
- *Jun 08: 2,000 members of the National Guard were deployed against anti-ICE protestors in Los Angeles, California.*
- *Jun 12: Air India Flight 171 from Ahmedabad, India, to London crashed 30 seconds after taking off, killing all but 1.*
- *Jun 28: Up to 200,000 people took to Budapest's streets to participate in a banned Pride march.*
- *Jul 01: France enacted a nationwide ban on smoking in public outdoor spaces, including beaches, parks, and areas near schools.*
- *Jul 11: A new Guinness World Record was set in Tijuana, Mexico, for the largest margarita ever, with a volume of 34,419 liters (7,579.7 imperial gallons).*
- *Jul 29: 65,000 fans gathered in London to celebrate the Lionesses' winning the Euro 2025 soccer championship.*
- *Jul 30: Russia's Klyuchevskoy Volcano erupted on the Kamchatka Peninsula, coinciding with an 8.8 magnitude earthquake.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in February	February 16 – February 23

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
February 10 – General Holiday February 11 – General Holiday February 12 – Election Holiday February 21 – Martyr's Day	February 19 – February 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
February 18 – Bank Holiday	**No holidays in February**

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ALANG - Port Position as of February 06, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Olga L*	*3,734*	*Reefer*	*Delivered February 05*
2	*Rising Harrier*	*8,553*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered February 03*
3	Woodchip	22,800	Oil Tanker	Arrived January 29
4	*Yun Da You 6*	*1,139*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 01*
Morality		**36,226**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of February 06, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Chang Ming Yang*	*19,529*	*Tanker*	*Delivered February 05*
2	*Fuji*	*950*	*Tanker*	*Delivered February 04*
3	*Hakata*	*354*	*Tanker*	*Delivered February 03*
4	Hansung	2,731	RoRo	Arrived February 05
5	*Hong Li*	*6,132*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered February 03*
		29,695		

GADANI - Port Position as of February 06, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sheng Le	6,961	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 04
Total Tonnage		**6,961**		

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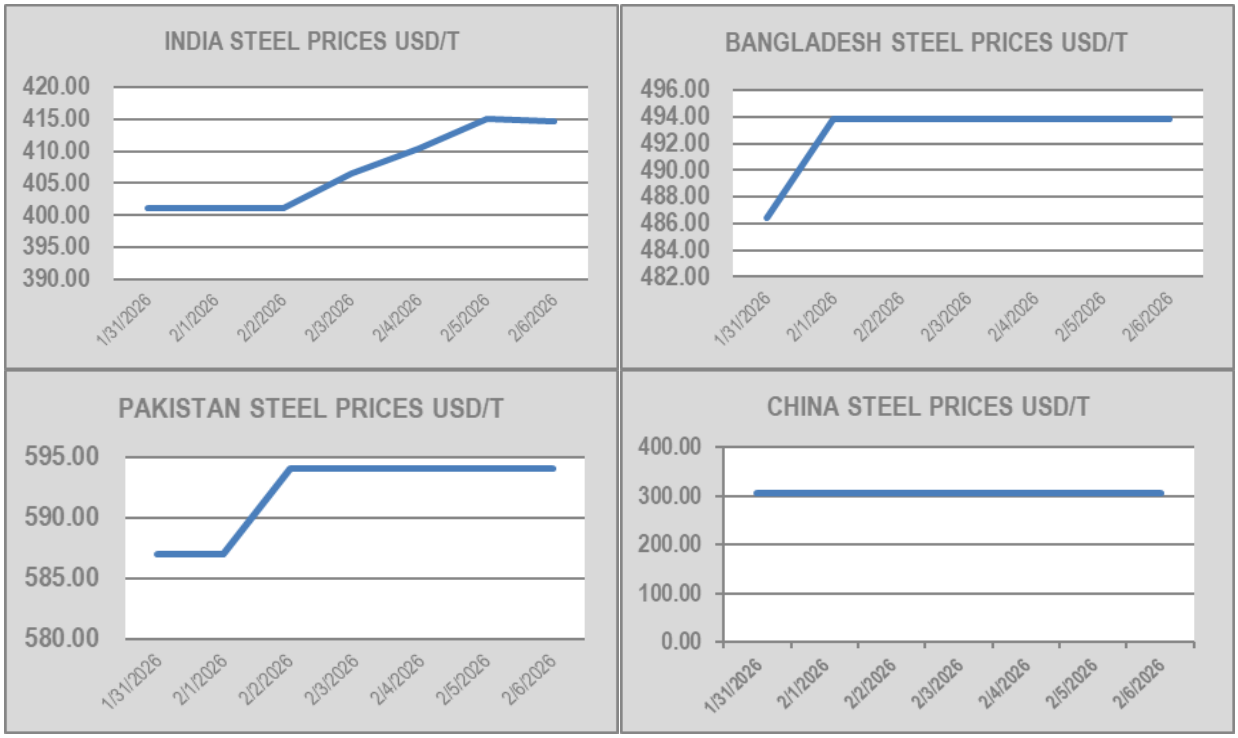
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
1/31/2026	401.17	36,900.00	586.98	165,000.00	486.44	59,200.00	307.84
2/1/2026	401.17	36,900.00	586.98	165,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/2/2026	401.05	36,700.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/3/2026	406.60	36,700.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/4/2026	410.31	37,100.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/5/2026	415.01	37,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/6/2026	414.64	37,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84



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